

Is it plausible to require every new data center to provide it's own zero carbon power?

Posted by u/thikskuld • 0 points • 6 comments

The extra load added to the power grid by data centers is tremendous. Can they be required to provide their own? Is it economically feasible?

Comments

u/Miserable-Whereas910 • 1 points • 2025-06-06 03:06 UTC

Is it plausible to require every new data center fund renewable energy projects that add the same total amount of carbon neutral energy to the grid daily as those data centers use? Sure.

Is it plausible to require every data center to be directly, purely powered by carbon neutral energy sources? That's gonna require either a huge investment in batteries or nuclear energy, probably larger than is realistic in the short term.

u/Concise_Pirate • 2 points • 2025-06-05 13:04 UTC

No. They use a huge amount of power and are under pressure to open quickly.

u/DAmieba • 1 points • 2025-06-05 13:03 UTC

I think it's a reasonable requirement and if the data centers can't meet it they should be closed

u/NaturalSelectorX • 2 points • 2025-06-05 12:04 UTC

I'm not in favor of requiring data center operators to get into the power generation business. It's more efficient to centralize power generation. I'd rather require power companies to go renewable when they need to upgrade their capacity.

u/Jficek34 • -2 points • 2025-06-05 12:23 UTC

Renewable energy will never be an option. It's too unstable and underpowered for data center. You need constant, high output

u/CaptCynicalPants • 6 points • 2025-06-05 12:00 UTC

Only if you're going to approve them all being hooked in to nuclear power plants

Which I am 100% in favor of, btw.

u/mmaalex • 1 points • 2025-06-07 13:37 UTC

Hope youre good waiting a decade for those to each be built...

u/Broke-car-guy • 4 points • 2025-06-05 12:18 UTC

Well Three Mile Island will be reactivated with Microsoft funding to power their data centers. I don't know how many cases you could apply this strategy to, but it's still a way to get more sustainable power